



FLIP THROUGH BEFORE YOU DOWNLOAD

Ask for a Setup Screen

Three real pages, straight off the shipping files,
plus everything the full download includes.



What a setup screen is, and what belongs on it

A screen inside the tool, reached from a button, where **everything that is yours rather than the tool's** gets typed in. Your questions. Your class list. Your prices. Your room. Nothing else.

Three questions decide what goes on it

- 1 • **Would a different teacher need to change this?** Your questions, yes. The color of the buttons, no. **If everybody would change it, it belongs on the screen.**
- 2 • **Would *you* change it again next term?** A class list changes every year and a price list changes every month. Those belong on the screen even if nobody else would touch them.
- 3 • **Does getting it wrong break the tool?** If the answer is yes, it belongs on the screen **with a check beside it** — not in the code where a stray character ends the lesson.

And the test that settles any argument

Hand the file to a colleague who has never seen it and say **nothing**. If they can make it theirs, the screen is right. If they ask you a question, the answer to that question belongs on the screen. The same rule as user testing, and the same reason it works.

What should not go on it

Everything else. A setup screen with thirty options is a settings menu, and a settings menu is a thing people close. **Six to ten fields is a tool. Thirty is a chore.** If you cannot decide, leave it out — it is far easier to add a field later than to take one away from somebody who started using it.

The reason this is the most useful thing on this page.

A tool you can change is a tool you still use in March. **Everything else about building with AI is downstream of whether the thing survives contact with a second week.**

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Written out, and what to do when it ignores you

Add this to whatever you were going to ask for. It works on a new build and it works on something you already have.

ADD TO ANY BUILD REQUEST

Put a **setup screen inside the file**, reached from a button, where I can change the content without editing any code or opening a text editor.

On it: **<list the things that are yours – questions, names, prices>**

Rules:

- It saves what I type and still has it when I reopen the file.
- It tells me when something I typed will not work, and says why.
- Everything else stays where it is. Do not redesign the rest.

WHEN IT HANDS YOU A CODE BLOCK ANYWAY

That still asks me to edit code. I need a **screen with input boxes**, inside the running page, that a person who has never seen code could use. Keep everything as is. It is what it is.

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The three things it will get wrong, and they are the same three every time

It forgets. You type your questions in, close the file, reopen it, and they are gone. Ask for it to still be there after a reload, in those words.

It redesigns everything else. You asked for a screen and got a new color scheme. Say "do not change anything I did not ask about" and say it again if you have to.

It accepts anything. A blank field, a stray comma, a duplicate — all swallowed, and the tool quietly misbehaves later. The next page is about that one, because it is the one that costs you a lesson.

Say what should be true, not what to build.

"A screen a person who has never seen code could use" is a requirement you can check. "A nice settings page" is a wish. **The first one gets tested; the second gets agreed with.**

Let AI fill the screen, and make the parser honest

A setup screen you have to type into by hand on a Sunday is still work. **The second half of the request is a paste box**, and a prompt that fills it in about thirty seconds.

ADD THIS TO THE SAME REQUEST

Also give me a **paste box** on the setup screen that accepts a plain list, one item per line, and a **copy button for a prompt** I can paste into any AI chat tool to produce that list in the right format.

Why one item per line beats anything cleverer

It is the format a spreadsheet column already gives you, it is the format an AI returns without being argued with, and **it is the only format you can check by looking at it**. If you need more than one piece of information per line, separate them with a vertical bar rather than a comma — **commas are already in your content** and a comma format breaks the first time somebody writes "Smith, Alex".

The one parser rule, and it is the only one

Ask for this in those words: **"If a line cannot be used, tell me which line and why, and keep the rest."**

The default behavior is to silently skip anything it does not understand. **You paste thirty questions, twenty-eight load, and nothing tells you** — and you find out in front of a class. A parser that names what it dropped turns a lost lesson into four seconds of reading.

And the instruction that always goes with the drafting prompt

Read what it gives you before you use it. AI will write you twenty plausible review questions in thirty seconds and two of them will be wrong, or off your standard, or ask something you have not taught yet. **Thirty seconds of drafting still needs two minutes of reading**, and you own the standards either way.

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WHAT IS INSIDE

Ask for a Setup Screen

- ✓ The one sentence to add to any build request
- ✓ Three questions that decide what goes on the screen
- ✓ What should not go on it, and why thirty fields fails
- ✓ The three things AI gets wrong every time
- ✓ The paste box, and the parser rule worth the download
- ✓ A fill-in page to design it before you ask

Running it with your whole staff? Additional teacher licenses are just \$0, and we accept purchase orders through TpT for Schools.

